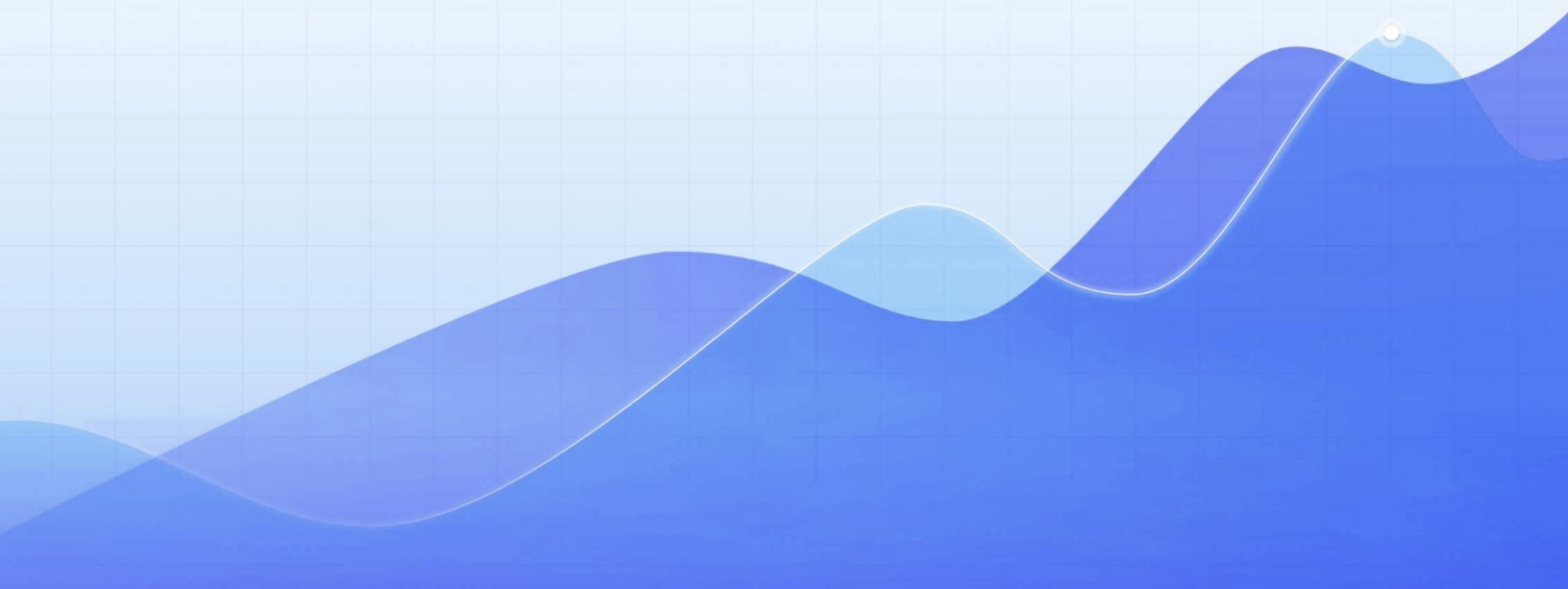


SALARY NEGOTIATION SCRIPTS

Recruiter Screening Call

How to handle the “gotcha” questions from recruiters like “What are your salary expectations?”



How to use this resource

Hello,

My name is Alex Immel, Founder & CEO of [Next Level Negotiation](#). I created this resource for you because according to a [Fidelity study](#), **only 42% of job seekers negotiate their salary** yet nearly 9/10 are successful when they do.

Salary negotiation is daunting and can be scary. However, the more prepared you are, the less scary it becomes and the more confident you can be on the phone — a key to success for any conversation as important as your salary negotiation.

Part of being prepared means being ready to answer the recruiter's tough questions, knowing what to say when you get the offer, and handling objections. So, use this script as a guide for your next negotiation and I promise you'll have a great outcome.

That being said, it's not enough to just have a script ready. If you sound scripted, the recruiter will see right through it. You need to practice your responses until you feel comfortable without using the script. Talk to a friend, a coach, a mentor, yourself in the mirror, or with your dog. Doesn't matter — just get comfortable with the content because HOW you say it is just as important as what you say.

Good luck! You got this.



Alex Immel
Founder & CEO

P.S. If you want more in-depth personalized support with your salary negotiation, Next Level Negotiation has you covered. We have 10+ years of experience helping people negotiate \$26k average salary increases. Our model is 100% performance based, meaning you owe \$0 upfront and only pay if we successfully help you increase your salary.

[Visit our website](#)

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Recruiter Screening Call

How to Handle “Gotcha” Questions

Contrary to what you may think, negotiation doesn't start at the offer stage of the interview process. It starts with the initial recruiter screening call when they ask you, “what are your salary expectations?”, or what we like to say, a “gotcha” question.

Recruiters ask this question to qualify your fit for the role. The problem is if you answer with a specific number or a range, you're setting yourself up for failure because...

- If you give a number too low, you undervalue yourself and when you reach the offer stage they will use that expectation to low-ball you.
- If you give a number too high, you may disqualify yourself from the interview process right away because you are out of their budget.

STRATEGY



Turn the question around to them and ask for the budget. If it's close to your expectations, move forward. If not, respectfully end the interview process so you don't waste any more time.

Recruiter: *What are your salary expectations?*



I'm aiming for the best that you can offer and confident I can deliver on that value but I understand companies have budgets and set pay bands for each role. Would you be able to share that budget so I can let you know if it meets my expectations?

OR



I know each organization is set up differently with their compensation packages between base salary, bonuses, equity. With that being said, can you help me understand what the comp package consists of and the salary range the team has budgeted for the role? This will help me give you a better answer.

Recruiter Screening Call

If the recruiter shares the range, answer like this:



Thanks for sharing! This is very helpful. My expectations were initially a bit higher than the high end of the range you provided but I can be flexible for the right position. I'm really excited about this opportunity so I'd love to move forward.

If the recruiter continues to push, share a big range:



From the initial research I've done, it seems like the total compensation can be anywhere from \$xx,xxx - \$xxx,xxx.

I know that's a big range but I'm not certain what would make sense until I know more about the role after going through the interview process.

I'm really just looking for a fair market rate based on my skills, experience, and where I can add value in the organization.

Another “gotcha” question you might get is asking about your current salary. NEVER answer this unless you already have an offer in-hand that is less than what you're currently making.

Recruiter: *What is your current salary?*



I'm sorry, I consider that personal information and don't feel comfortable sharing.

What I'm really looking for is a role where I can immediately make an impact and be a significant part of a company's growth.

NEXT LEVEL NEGOTIATION

www.nextlevelnegotiation.com

